

You Have 4 Months Left.

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Sep 05, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SFKT1zUcpfs> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

With ~120 days left in the year, Brandon Carter argues that waiting for January 1st is a procrastination trap. He delivers a concrete 6-step tactical system to sprint to the finish line and enter the new year already winning.

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The January 1st Myth 0:00

- Millions of people have already mentally quit and are coasting toward September, planning to "lock in" on January 1st
 - October gets busy, then Thanksgiving, then Christmas — the year just slides away
 - Common promises deferred to Jan 1: lose weight, start a business, make real money, start making content
- **January 1st is an arbitrary, imaginary date** — nothing magical changes
 - You won't wake up with more discipline
 - Your metabolism won't change
 - You won't suddenly become better at sales or stop procrastinating
- "People use dates as permission to procrastinate" — 'I'll start Monday,' 'after vacation,' 'after the holidays' — it's all the same thing
 - "Procrastination disguised as planning."

- The average American gains **10–15 pounds** during the holidays — coasting now means starting the new year further behind
- Four months is a long time:
 - Long enough to completely change your body
 - Dramatically change your income
 - Publish 50, 100, maybe 200 pieces of content
 - Learn a new skill, build a business, change habits and environment
- The frame shift: don't think "I only have four months" — think "**I have four months. Let's get after it.**"

🎯 Step 1: Turn Your Goal Into Math [1:54](#)

- Pick **one target, two at most** — not 30 things
 - Ask: "If I accomplished one thing by December 31st, what would make me look back at 2026 and say this year counted?"
 - Write it down; put it in the comments
- "A goal without math behind it is basically just a wish"
- **Example: Fat loss goal**
 - Don't write "I want to get ripped by January" — that's not a plan
 - The prescription:
 - Calories: body weight in pounds $\times$ 10 = daily calorie target
 - Protein: 1 gram per pound of body weight
 - Steps: 20,000 per day
- Why an aggressive calorie deficit (not just 200–500 calories):
 - The FDA allows food labels to be off by **20%** — a "500 calorie" item could be 600 calories
 - A few label errors per day can wipe out a small deficit entirely
 - Brandon has trained thousands of people using aggressive deficits
- Why 1g protein per pound of bodyweight (not just the 1.7g/kg from studies):
 - Higher protein preserves muscle on an aggressive deficit
 - **Thermogenic effect of protein:** the body burns 20–30% of protein calories in digestion
 - Fat: only ~3% burned in digestion
 - Carbs: ~10–15% burned in digestion
 - Protein: **20–30%** burned in digestion
 - Practical result: eat 100 calories of protein, absorb only ~70–80 net calories — "a goddamn cheat code"
 - Less than 2% of the global population is 300 lb, so the "300g protein" objection applies to almost no one
- How to hit 20,000 steps per day:
 - Walk 30 minutes immediately after waking up
 - Walk 30 minutes after lunch

- Walk 60 minutes after work
- Every hour at work, get up and walk for ~10 minutes
- **Example: Revenue goal**
 - Goal: make \$20K/month
 - If average sale = \$1,000, you need 20 sales
 - Work backwards: how many appointments to get 20 sales? How many leads to get those appointments?
 - Keep breaking the goal down until it becomes daily measurable math
- **Example: Audience growth goal**
 - How many videos will you post over 120 days? 1/day? 5/week?
 - Instagram CEO confirmed: the more you post, the faster you grow
- The principle: "Everything in life is just math" — stop overcomplicating it with cold plunges, bed-making, no-fap rituals ("the male equivalent of astrology")

Step 2: Stop Obsessing Over Lagging Indicators 14:28

- **Lagging indicators** = outcomes you can't directly control day-to-day
 - Examples: the scale, bank account balance, follower count, video views, revenue
 - They just show you what already happened — like a Super Bowl win showing years of prior practice
- **Leading indicators** = the actions that *create* the results — obsess over these

Goal	Leading Indicators to Track
Get lean	Daily calories consumed, protein hit?, steps taken, workouts completed
Build business	Outreach attempts per day, appointments booked, sales calls taken
Grow audience	Scripts written, videos filmed, videos posted per day

- Fat loss math example:
 - To lose 1 lb of fat = burn 3,500 calories
 - 500 calorie daily deficit × 7 days = 3,500 calories = **1 lb fat/week**
 - 1,000 calorie daily deficit × 7 days = 7,000 calories = **2 lbs fat/week**
 - Track with a wearable; focus on the inputs, not the scale
- Make it a **scoreboard**: every day you either hit the numbers or you didn't — no ambiguity
 - Eliminates the lie of "I've been working really hard"
 - "Don't tell me how you feel. Show me what you did."
 - "Men lie, women lie, but the numbers don't."
- Community member example — posting frequency:
 - Members making the most money post **5 reels per day**
 - A struggling member said he was "posting a lot" — turned out to be twice last week

- "You got exactly what you were supposed to get"
- **Case study — Jen Caesar:**
 - Full-time nurse practitioner, two young boys, husband — extremely busy
 - Joined Brandon's community with no certifications, just a love of fitness
 - Committed to posting **4–5 videos per day, every day**
 - April revenue: **\$49,927** (just missed \$50K with one fewer day in the month)
 - By mid-May: already at **\$12,577**
 - Result was predictable because the leading indicators were being hit consistently



Step 3: Your Calendar Is Your Secret Weapon 19:47

- Every week has **168 hours** — everyone gets the same amount
- "Most people don't have a time problem. They have a time allocation problem."
 - Common time wasters: 2 hours Netflix, 90 minutes Instagram scrolling, hours of other passive consumption
- **Plan every single hour of every day in your calendar**
 - Include: sleep, job, family obligations, workouts, content creation, business work
 - Put family in the calendar — not neglecting them, *scheduling* them
 - Then look at what's left — that's your opportunity time
- If you claim something is important but it's not in your calendar, you're interested — not committed
- Specific calendar blocks to create:
 - Content creation / script writing: e.g., 6:00–8:00 AM
 - Filming block: specific day and time
 - Analytics review + content planning: e.g., Saturday morning
 - Workouts: a fixed recurring time slot
 - Prospecting / outreach: a dedicated daily block
- Check your phone screen time — "I bet we can find hours every day where you're out here bullshitting"
- Don't say "I'll work on my business this week" — say exactly *when*, down to the hour



Step 4: Win One Week at a Time 22:26

- Each week, pick your **Big Three** — the three things that must happen to make the week a success and move you toward the big goal
 - Protect those time blocks fiercely
- Hierarchy of focus:
 - Big annual/120-day goal
 - Weekly Big Three
 - Today's daily actions

- Don't wake up thinking about the giant monthly to-do list — think only about **winning today**
 - Stack 7 good days → 1 good week
 - Stack 4 good weeks → 1 good month
 - Stack 4 good months → people will ask "what the hell happened to you?"

Step 5: Create the Floor (No Zero Day Rule) 23:57

- Bad days *will* happen — travel, poor sleep, family emergencies, social invitations
- **Before** a bad day hits, decide what your minimum acceptable day looks like
- Examples of normal standard vs. floor minimum:

Metric	Normal Standard	Floor Minimum
Daily steps	20,000	10,000
Work block	3 hours	30 minutes
Outreach attempts	20	10

- The floor isn't optimal — it's a circuit breaker
 - Goal: don't let one bad day become three bad days
 - Do *something* every day to avoid breaking the habit entirely
- How people actually quit (it's never a dramatic declaration):
 - Miss one day → "this week is messed up, I'll restart Monday"
 - Monday comes → "I'll start next month"
 - Next month → "I'll start January 1st"
- "The goal is not perfection. The goal is to make quitting difficult."
- Starting over is the hardest part — the floor prevents you from ever having to fully restart

Step 6: Design Your Environment for Success 25:50

- Don't fight the same willpower battle every single day — engineer the environment so the right choice is the default
- **The friction concept:**
 - Amazon makes it easy to subscribe (low friction) but hard to cancel (high friction) — this is deliberate
 - Apply the same logic to your own behaviors
- To *reduce* a bad behavior → **increase friction** (make it harder to do)
 - Example: remove junk food from the house entirely
 - Brandon's rule: no ice cream (his weakness — could eat a whole Häagen-Dazs in 5 minutes) in the house
 - If he wants it, he has to go to the store or order delivery — extra steps = enough friction to abstain

- Put your phone in another room during important work blocks; lock it in the bathroom if needed
- To **increase** a good behavior → **decrease friction** (make it easier to do)
 - Brandon's morning system (working within 5 minutes of waking):
 - Phone alarm on the other side of a large bedroom — forces him to physically get up
 - Robe hanging by the door, Gucci flip flops right there — grab and go
 - Walk straight to the desk
 - Pre-workout already made the night before — chug immediately
 - Work already pulled up on screen from the night before
 - Result: working within **5 minutes** of waking at ~5:30 AM, no friction, no decisions
- Other environment fixes:
 - If you always skip the gym at 7 PM because you're exhausted, **move the workout to morning**
 - If certain people constantly pull you away from your goals, **stop spending time with them**
 - Get around people who have discipline — "discipline is contagious"
- "Not putting yourself in situations where you need discipline" is even better than having discipline

The Weekly Review 29:45

- Every 7 days, sit down and ask:
 - Did I do what I said I was going to do?
 - What numbers/metrics did I actually hit?
 - What did I miss, and **why** did I miss it?
 - What will I change next week to improve?
- Keep it analytical — not emotional, not a therapy session
 - The week's results aren't evidence that you're a good or bad person — it's just a scoreboard
- **Adjust the plan, never the goal:**
 - Your calorie target may have been unrealistic → adjust it
 - Your prospecting block may have been the wrong time → move it
 - You may be trying to film too many videos → recalibrate volume
 - Analogy: D-Day had a Plan B, but Plan B wasn't "let's just live with the Nazis" — it was a different **route** to the same goal
- The 120-day period should be **one giant feedback loop**: execute → measure → adjust → execute again
- Analogy: a sports team down at halftime doesn't concede — the coach makes adjustments and they play better in the second half
- Watch for inefficiencies: e.g., wasting 3 hours every Thursday on something that should have been delegated

Final Mindset: Day 121 vs. Day 1 32:25

- While everyone else is slowing down in Sept–Dec, **this is the opportunity to accelerate**
 - Gyms packed in January → empty by December → "it'll just be you"
 - September–December is when most people negotiate with themselves and make excuses
- "When everybody else slows down, you should be speeding up. When everybody else starts making excuses, you start stacking wins every day."
- Imagine January 1st from two positions:
 - **Everyone else:** Day 1, making resolutions, revving the engine from a cold start
 - **You:** Day 121, already have momentum, habits built, systems running, evidence of capability
- Real confidence isn't affirmations — it's having *evidence* that when you say you'll do something, you actually do it
- **The most dangerous habit:** teaching yourself that you need a special magical date before you're allowed to change
 - You don't need Monday. You don't need next month. You don't need January 1st.
- **Immediate action checklist (do this when the video ends):**
 - Turn your goal into math
 - Identify leading indicators for every month, week, and day — make it your scoreboard
 - Block everything in your calendar
 - Choose your weekly Big Three
 - Create your minimum standard for bad days
 - Optimize your environment to reduce friction on good behaviors
 - Review your numbers at least every 7 days
- **Case study — Corey Armstrong** (High Ticket Trainer community member):
 - Had been stuck trying to hit \$10K/month for a long time
 - Brandon told him he was out of shape and prescribed aggressive steps + calorie protocols
 - Corey got lean, then his business followed
 - Recent month: **\$40K**; full prior year: **\$470,000** (a record year)